

Parent Guide — middle / module-08- yoga

IKS Curriculum

Table of Contents

Parent Guide — Module 8: Yoga and the Body

Your child's age: Middle (Grades 6–8) · **Module length:** 10 sessions × 45 min (~15 min movement each)

What your child is learning

The classical yoga framework + safe modern practice:

- **Patañjali's eight limbs** (*aṣṭāṅga*): yama, niyama, āsana, prāṇāyāma, pratyāhāra, dhāraṇā, dhyāna, samādhi.
- **Five foundational āsanās:** tādāsana, vṛkṣāsana, baddha-koṇāsana, balāsana, sukhāsana.
- **Sūrya Namaskāra** — the 12-pose sun salutation, with breath co-ordination.
- **Counted-breath prāṇāyāma** — natural breath observation and 4-in/4-out counted breath.
- **The physiology:** why slow exhale shifts the body toward calm (vagus nerve, parasympathetic activation).

Safety — please read before Day 1

The school will send you a medical opt-out form. Please fill it in for: - Asthma, recent injury, recent surgery, pregnancy, severe ADHD, any musculoskeletal issue.

What we do NOT teach at this band: - No inversions (headstand, shoulder stand, plough). - No advanced backbends. - No breath retention (no bhastrikā, no kapālabhāti, no held breath).

Opt-out always allowed. Your child can sit out any movement, any time, no questions asked.

What to expect this fortnight

Daily settle: 2 minutes of seated breath awareness to start every class.

Movement: ~15 min per class. Building toward 1–2 rounds of Sūrya Namaskāra by Day 5.

Project (Days 8–10): Your child designs and leads a 5-minute yoga routine for a chosen audience — peers, parents, younger siblings, or classmates before an exam. On Day 10 they lead the whole class through their routine.

Reading: verses from the Bhagavad-gītā and Bhāgavata Purāṇa with translation (cached in the module's .rag-cache/ folder).

How to help

Helpful: - Try the stress-recovery sequence from Day 7 with your child: tādāsana 30s → uttānāsana 30s → balāsana 60s → counted breath 60s → tādāsana 30s. ~3.5 minutes. Use it before exams. - Allow comfortable clothing on yoga class days. - Be the “audience” for their project rehearsal at home. - Read the brief on what the eight limbs are — your child will be glad you know.

Not helpful: - Pushing depth in poses (“you should be able to touch your toes by now”). - Filming and sharing — yoga is a personal practice, not a performance. - Religious framing or dismissal — the classroom frame is *yoga as physical and philosophical practice with Indian roots, taught secularly*. We respect families’ devotional traditions; we don’t centre them.

A note on the religious dimension

Yoga has religious roots in India and is practised devotionally in many traditions. **In school we teach the physical and philosophical aspects in a secular frame.** Your child will read Patañjali’s classical text as primary historical source, not as scripture.

If your family has religious concerns, the school will arrange a written observation alternative.

A note on the modern-vs-classical distinction

Honest framing your child will encounter: - Patañjali’s eight-limb system is classical — c. 2nd century BCE – 4th century CE. - Modern *postural* yoga (the asana-heavy form taught in studios worldwide) is largely a 20th-century synthesis — drawing on classical Indian texts AND on European physical-culture movements. - Both are real. Both are Indian. The history is just more layered than most popular accounts suggest.

Senior band students read Singleton (2010) on this. Middle band gets a brief honest mention.

What success looks like

By end of module, your child can: - Name and perform 5 foundational āsanās safely. - Lead a 1-round Sūrya Namaskāra with breath co-ordination. - Do 5 minutes of counted-breath prāṇāyāma calmly. - Explain *why* slow exhale calms the body (vagus nerve, parasympathetic). - Teach a 5-minute routine to a chosen audience.

Want to go deeper?

Senior band (Grade 9–12) reads Patañjali’s *Yoga Sūtras* in IAST, engages the polyvagal-theory research, and writes a 5-page research-synthesis paper. Preview: [curriculum/senior/module-08-yoga/README.md](#).

10-Day Lesson Plan

Module 8 (Middle) — 10-Day Lesson Plan

At a glance

Day	Session title	Lesson file	Activity / assessment
1	What is Yoga?	days/day-01-hook.md	Tāḍāsana + 60-sec breath count
2	The Eight Limbs	days/day-02-eight-limbs.md	Limb-matching exit ticket
3	Five Foundational Āsanas	days/day-03-five-asanas.md	activities/activity-01-asana-practice.md
4	Sūrya Namaskāra — Part 1 (poses)	days/day-04-sun-salutation-1.md	Practical observation
5	Sūrya Namaskāra — Part 2 (flow) + mid-module check	days/day-05-sun-salutation-2.md	quizzes/formative.md Part B
6	Prāṇāyāma (Natural Breath)	days/day-06-pranayama.md	activities/activity-02-breath-observation.md
7	Physiology Connection	days/day-07-physiology.md	Concept check
8	Project Session 1	days/day-08-project-session-1.md	Project draft
9	Project Session 2	days/day-09-project-session-2.md	Project draft
10	Final Assessment + Showcase	days/day-10-final-assessment.md	quizzes/summative.md + 3-min routine

Daily structure

Each class follows the same broad shape:

	Time	What
Settle	2 min	Sit on mat, eyes closed, 5 natural breaths
Theory	8–12 min	Concept of the day
Practice	15–20 min	Movement / breath work

	Time	What
Discussion	5–8 min	What did you notice?
Close	2 min	Tāḍāsana + namaste

Pacing notes

- This module is movement-heavy. **Confirm the space** the day before — yoga mats laid out, no chairs in the way.
- Days 4 and 5 (Sūrya Namaskāra) are the most demanding physically. Build the cumulative practice slowly. If your class is struggling, halve the rounds; quality of movement beats quantity.
- Day 6 (prāṇāyāma) is restricted to **natural-breath observation only** at this band. Do not teach forceful breath retention (kumbhaka), bhastrikā, or kapālabhāti.

Daily warm-up

Every class opens with **2 minutes of seated awareness**: students sit in *sukhāsana* (easy cross-legged seat), close their eyes, and count 5 natural breaths. This is the foundational *settling* practice — by Day 10 students should do it without prompting.

What students leave the module with

- Five safe foundational āsanās they can practise unsupervised at home.
- A complete Sūrya Namaskāra sequence with breath co-ordination.
- A natural-breath observation practice (no breath retention).
- The eight-limb framework as a “map” of the yoga tradition.
- One designed 5-minute routine they can share.

Homework

Homework — Module 8 Yoga (Middle)

Day 1 → Day 2

Task: Practice tāḍāsana for 60 seconds tomorrow morning before brushing your teeth. Notice how your body feels.

Time: 2 min + observation.

Day 2 → Day 3

Task: Memorise the 8 limbs in order. Practise tāḍāsana + vṛkṣāsana for 5 min before breakfast.

Time: 10 min.

Day 3 → Day 4

Task: Choose 3 of the 5 foundational āsanās. Practise them for 5 min before bed. Note in workbook: how you felt before vs. after.

Time: 10 min.

Day 4 → Day 5

Task: Practise 1 round of Sūrya Namaskāra at home, slowly. Note which transitions felt awkward.

Time: 5 min.

Day 5 → Day 6

Task: Practise 1 round of SN with breath co-ordination. Submit project plan paragraph.

Time: 15 min.

Day 6 → Day 7

Task: Practise the counted breath (4 in, 4 out) for 3 minutes before bed. Note: “Felt _____ before, _____ after.”

Time: 5 min.

Day 7 → Day 8

Task: Practise the stress-recovery sequence at least once. Bring all project materials tomorrow.

Time: 5 min + material gathering.

Day 8 → Day 9

Task: Practise your full 5-min routine at home. Finish anything that wasn’t done in class.

Time: 15 min.

Day 9 → Day 10

Task: Practise the routine one more time. Bring everything tomorrow.

Time: 10 min.